

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Analyst | Defensive Operations | Microsoft Sentinel and Defender XDR | Threat Hunting | Detection Engineering | Incident Response

United Kingdom (Hybrid/Remote) | +44 7403 190750 | prosper.awuni@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/awuniprosper

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a senior cyber security analyst specialising in defensive operations, with over five years of hands-on experience in Security Operations Centre (SOC) analysis, advanced incident response, threat hunting, and detection engineering. I have strong proficiency with Microsoft Sentinel, including Kusto Query Language (KQL) query development, analytics rule authoring, and investigation workbook design, alongside Microsoft Defender Extended Detection and Response (XDR) across endpoint, identity, and email telemetry. I am experienced in conducting advanced investigations escalated from managed SOC providers, performing root cause analysis, evidence gathering, containment, and remediation across complex enterprise environments. I apply the MITRE ATT&CK framework to threat hunt planning, detection gap analysis, and the conversion of threat intelligence into actionable detection rules. I hold the Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) certification and bring a disciplined, evidence-based approach to protecting organisations from evolving adversary techniques.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Microsoft Sentinel (Security Information and Event Management - SIEM):** KQL query development for detection, investigation, and threat hunting; analytics rule authoring; incident investigation workbooks; watchlists; data connector management - Strong
- **Microsoft Defender Extended Detection and Response (XDR):** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender; alert triage, advanced hunting, and automated response - Strong
- **Threat Hunting and Detection Engineering:** MITRE ATT&CK-based hunt planning; detection gap analysis; converting threat intelligence into Sentinel analytics rules and hunt queries; tuning recommendations - Strong
- **Incident Response:** NIST SP 800-61 incident response lifecycle - detection, analysis, containment, eradication, recovery, lessons learned; advanced investigation of escalated MDR SOC incidents; root cause analysis; evidence gathering - Strong
- **CrowdStrike Falcon:** Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR), Prevent, Insight, Discover, NG-SIEM - Expert; alert investigation, threat hunting, and sensor policy management
- **Vulnerability Management and Breach Simulation:** Tenable.io, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), AppCheck, Nessus; risk-prioritised remediation aligned to MITRE ATT&CK and CIS Controls
- **Identity and Access Management (IAM):** Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory), Conditional Access, MFA, Single Sign-On (SSO), BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR):** Playbook development and automation in Microsoft Sentinel; CrowdStrike SOAR integrations; PowerShell scripting
- **Security Frameworks:** MITRE ATT&CK, NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, CIS Controls

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

March 2025 - Present

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

- Conduct advanced investigations escalated from the managed Security Operations Centre (SOC) and internally identified threats, performing root cause analysis, evidence gathering, containment, and remediation across Microsoft Sentinel and Microsoft Defender XDR
- Support and lead incident response activities through the full NIST SP 800-61 lifecycle: detection, analysis, containment, eradication, recovery, and lessons learned; produce post-incident reports and recommend security improvements

- Develop and execute structured threat hunts based on threat intelligence, MITRE ATT&CK gap analysis, and incident learnings, converting findings into new detection rules and tuning recommendations within Microsoft Sentinel
- Author KQL analytics rules, scheduled queries, and investigation workbooks in Microsoft Sentinel to detect adversary techniques across identity, endpoint, email, and network telemetry
- Manage the technical configuration, maintenance, and operation of security tooling including CrowdStrike Falcon, Microsoft Sentinel, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and Mimecast
- Develop and maintain Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel to automate alert enrichment, triage, and containment actions, reducing mean time to respond (MTTR)
- Perform detection engineering: analyse attacker techniques from threat intelligence reports, map to MITRE ATT&CK, assess detection coverage, and develop new analytics rules to close identified gaps
- Oversee vulnerability management using Tenable.io and Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS); integrate vulnerability findings with threat intelligence to prioritise remediation effort
- Provide security guidance to IT teams, support policy development, and contribute to the continuous improvement of the organisation's defensive security programme

Cyber Security Analyst - Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

- Investigated security alerts escalated from the managed SOC; performed deep-dive analysis across Microsoft Sentinel, CrowdStrike Falcon EDR, and Microsoft Defender XDR, managing incidents from initial triage through containment and remediation
- Built and tuned Microsoft Sentinel KQL analytics rules and investigation workbooks; authored custom detection content covering identity-based attacks, endpoint compromise, phishing, and lateral movement techniques
- Conducted threat hunts aligned to MITRE ATT&CK, developing hypotheses from threat intelligence and incident learnings, and converting outcomes into new detection rules or policy enhancements
- Deployed and administered CrowdStrike Falcon EDR across the UAL estate; managed prevention policies, sensor health, exclusions, and Insight/Discover modules to maintain full endpoint telemetry
- Developed SOAR playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel to automate alert enrichment and triage steps; integrated with Microsoft Defender for Endpoint for automated containment actions
- Supported incident response activities and post-incident reviews; documented lessons learned and updated detection rules and response runbooks accordingly
- Administered Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory) Conditional Access, MFA, and BeyondTrust PAM to enforce least-privilege and Zero Trust identity controls
- Ran vulnerability assessments with Tenable.io and Nessus; mapped findings to MITRE ATT&CK attack paths and supported risk-based remediation prioritisation

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 - March 2022

HICX Solutions Ltd (Software as a Service / FinTech)

- Monitored and investigated security alerts across endpoint, identity, and network telemetry; supported incident response and escalation processes in a cloud-first SaaS environment
- Managed endpoint security tools, MFA, SSO, and access control processes, maintaining a secure operational baseline across corporate infrastructure
- Conducted vulnerability scans and patch management; maintained asset inventories and tracked remediation activities aligned to security policy
- Contributed to ISO 27001 compliance activities, supporting risk assessments and the documentation of security controls

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Developed a detection engineering programme at UAL, authoring over 40 custom KQL analytics rules in Microsoft Sentinel covering MITRE ATT&CK techniques including credential theft, lateral movement, persistence, and data exfiltration

- Led advanced incident investigations across Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon, including a multi-stage phishing and account compromise incident affecting over 200 student accounts, achieving full containment within two hours
- Designed and executed structured threat hunts based on MITRE ATT&CK gap analysis, identifying previously undetected attacker behaviour and converting findings into new Sentinel detection rules
- Built a Microsoft Sentinel SOAR automation library in Microsoft Sentinel, reducing analyst triage time for common alert types by automating enrichment, entity mapping, and initial containment actions
- Deployed CrowdStrike Falcon EDR across UAL's 8,000-user estate achieving full endpoint coverage and enabling proactive threat hunting across endpoint telemetry
- Integrated Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS) with the vulnerability management programme, aligning remediation priorities to real-world adversary attack paths validated against MITRE ATT&CK

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
-

References available on request | Hybrid (London/UK)